

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

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Graduate Recruitment Team

KPMG

1 Harbourmaster Place, IFSC

Dublin 1, Ireland

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Corporate Finance & Transaction Services Graduate Programme 2027 in Dublin. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. KPMG Ireland's record as the leading corporate finance adviser to Ireland's renewable energy industry, and the energy-transition focus within its M&A team, connects directly to my research on European gas markets.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Investment banking appeals to me because every transaction is a chain of judgements about who should buy, why now and at what price, and each one has to survive scrutiny from clients and counterparties. The analyst's part in that chain is accuracy under deadline, a habit I have built outside the classroom. For nearly two years at KONG, I reconciled end-of-shift cash and card takings while studying full-time. I now run the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, where I wrote the batch specifications and trained around 15 bar staff to standards that have to hold when someone else executes them.

KPMG Ireland's Deal Advisory team stands out to me because it has been the leading corporate finance adviser to Irish renewable energy for two decades, and it now runs M&A work with a dedicated energy-transition focus alongside debt advisory, valuations and infrastructure. My dissertation studies how gas storage, prices and news interact as Europe's energy system changes, and I would like to apply that understanding to the transactions that fund the transition while working towards a professional qualification.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan